
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

UNIT 1 ASPECTS OF DRAMATIC TRAGEDY

Thursday 16 May 2019

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford AQA Exams 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book. The **Examining Body** for this paper is AQA.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work that you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.

Section A: Shakespearean and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello and Desdemona
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 2

Enter Othello with a light, and Desdemona in her bed asleep

OTHELLO

It is the cause, it is the cause, my soul –
 Let me not name it to you, you chaste stars:
 It is the cause. Yet I'll not shed her blood,
 Nor scar that whiter skin of hers than snow
 And smooth as monumental alabaster –
 Yet she must die, else she'll betray more men.
 Put out the light, and then put out the light –
 If I quench thee, thou flaming minister,
 I can again thy former light restore,
 Should I repent me; but once put out thine,
 Thou cunning'st pattern of excelling nature,
 I know not where is that Promethean heat
 That can thy light relume. When I have pluck'd thy
 rose,
 I cannot give it vital growth again,
 It needs must wither: I'll smell thee on the tree –
 He kisses her
 Oh balmy breath, that dost almost persuade
 Justice to break her sword – one more, one more!
 He kisses her
 Be thus when thou art dead, and I will kill thee
 And love thee after – one more, and that's the last.
 He kisses her
 So sweet was ne'er so fatal. I must weep,
 But they are cruel tears: this sorrow's heavenly,
 It strikes where it doth love. She wakes.

DESDEMONA

Who's there? Othello?

OTHELLO

Ay, Desdemona.

DESDEMONA

Will you come to bed, my lord?

OTHELLO

Have you prayed tonight, Desdemon?

DESDEMONA

Ay, my lord.

OTHELLO

If you bethink yourself of any crime
Unreconciled as yet to heaven and grace,
Solicit for it straight.

DESDEMONA

Alack, my lord, what may you mean by that?

OTHELLO

Well, do it, and be brief; I will walk by:
I would not kill thy unprepared spirit,
No – heavens forbend! – I would not kill thy soul.

DESDEMONA

Talk you of killing?

OTHELLO

Ay, I do.

DESDEMONA

Then heaven

Have mercy on me.

OTHELLO

Amen, with all my heart.

DESDEMONA

If you say so, I hope you will not kill me.

OTHELLO Humh!

DESDEMONA

And yet I fear you, for you're fatal then
When your eyes roll so. Why I should fear I know not,
Since guiltiness I know not; but yet I feel I fear.

OTHELLO Think on thy sins.

DESDEMONA They are loves I bear to you.

OTHELLO Ay, and for that thou diest.

DESDEMONA

That death's unnatural that kills for loving.
Alas, why gnaw you so your nether lip?
Some bloody passion shakes your very frame:
These are portents; but yet I hope, I hope,
They do not point on me.

OTHELLO Peace, and be still.

DESDEMONA I will so. What's the matter?

OTHELLO

That handkerchief which I so loved and gave thee,
Thou gav'st to Cassio.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Edmund and Gloucester
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 2

Enter Edmund the bastard

EDMUND

Thou, nature, art my goddess. To thy law
My services are bound. Wherefore should I
Stand in the plague of custom and permit
The curiosity of nations to deprive me
For that I am some twelve or fourteen moonshines
Lag of a brother? Why 'bastard'? Wherefore 'base',
When my dimensions are as well compact,
My mind as generous, and my shape as true
As honest madam's issue?
Why brand they us with 'base, base bastardy',
Who in the lusty stealth of nature take
More composition and fierce quality
Than doth within a stale, dull-eyed bed go
To the creating a whole tribe of fops
Got 'tween a sleep and wake? Well then,
Legitimate Edgar, I must have your land.
Our father's love is to the bastard Edmund
As to the legitimate. Well, my legitimate, if
This letter speed and my invention thrive,
Edmund the base shall to th' legitimate.
I grow, I prosper. Now, gods, stand up for bastards!

Enter the Earl of Gloucester. Edmunds reads a letter

GLOUCESTER

Kent banished thus, and France in choler parted,
And the King gone tonight, subscribed his power,
Confined to exhibition – all this done
Upon the gad! – Edmund, how now! What news?

EDMUND So please your lordship, none.

GLOUCESTER Why so earnestly seek you to put up that letter?

EDMUND I know no news, my lord.

GLOUCESTER What paper were you reading?

EDMUND Nothing, my lord.

GLOUCESTER No? What needs then that terrible dispatch of it into your pocket? The quality of nothing hath not such need to hide itself. Let's see. Come, if it be nothing, I shall not need spectacles.

EDMUND I beseech you, sir, pardon me. It is a letter from my brother that I have not all o'er-read; for so much as I have perused, I find it not fit for your liking.

GLOUCESTER Give me the letter, sir.

EDMUND I shall offend either to detain or give it. The contents, as in part I understand them, are to blame.

GLOUCESTER Let's see, let's see!

EDMUND I hope for my brother's justification, he wrote this but as an essay or taste of my virtue.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Hamlet
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 2

HORATIO You will lose this wager, my lord.

HAMLET I do not think so. Since he went into France, I have been in continual practice. I shall win at the odds. But thou wouldst not think how ill all's here about my heart. But it is no matter.

HORATIO Nay, good my lord –

HAMLET It is but foolery. But it is such a kind of gain-giving as would perhaps trouble a woman.

HORATIO

If your mind dislike anything, obey it. I will forestall their repair hither, and say you are not fit.

HAMLET Not a whit. We defy augury. There's a special providence in the fall of a sparrow. If it be now, 'tis not to come. If it be not to come, it will be now. If it be not now, yet it will come. The readiness is all. Since no man knows aught of what he leaves, what is't to leave betimes? Let be. *A table prepared. Trumpets, Drums, and Officers with cushions.*

Enter Claudius, Gertrude, Laertes, Osric, and all the State, and Attendants with foils and gauntlets

CLAUDIUS

Come, Hamlet, come, and take this hand from me.

He puts Laertes's hand into Hamlet's

HAMLET (to Laertes)

Give me your pardon, sir. I've done you wrong;

But pardon't, as you are a gentleman.

This presence knows, and you must needs have heard,

How I am punished with sore distraction.

What I have done

That might your nature, honour, and exception

Roughly awake, I here proclaim was madness.

Was't Hamlet wronged Laertes? Never Hamlet.

If Hamlet from himself be ta'en away,
And when he's not himself does wrong Laertes,
Then Hamlet does it not, Hamlet denies it.
Who does it then? His madness. If't be so,
Hamlet is of the faction that is wronged;
His madness is poor Hamlet's enemy.
Sir, in this audience,
Let my disclaiming from a purposed evil
Free me so far in your most generous thoughts
That I have shot my arrow o'er the house
And hurt my brother.

LAERTES I am satisfied in nature,
Whose motive in this case should stir me most
To my revenge. But in my terms of honour
I stand aloof, and will no reconciliation
Till by some elder masters of known honour
I have a voice and precedent of peace
To keep my name ungored – but till that time
I do receive your offered love like love,
And will not wrong it.

HAMLET I do embrace it freely,
And will this brothers' wager frankly play. –
Give us the foils. Come on.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus
- Marlowe's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 1

Enter Wagner

FAUSTUS Commend me to my dearest friends,
The German Valdes and Cornelius.
Request them earnestly to visit me.

WAGNER I will, sir.

Exit [Wagner]

FAUSTUS Their conference will be a greater help to me
Than all my labours, plod I ne'er so fast.

Enter the [Good] Angel and Spirit, [i.e. the Bad Angel]

GOOD ANGEL O Faustus, lay that damnèd book aside
And gaze not on it, lest it tempt thy soul
And heap God's heavy wrath upon thy head!
Read, read the Scriptures. That is blasphemy.

BAD ANGEL Go forward, Faustus, in that famous art
Wherein all nature's treasure is contained.
Be thou on earth as Jove is in the sky,
Lord and commander of these elements.

Exeunt Angels

FAUSTUS How am I gluttèd with conceit of this!
Shall I make spirits fetch me what I please?
Resolve me of all ambiguities?
Perform what desperate enterprise I will?
I'll have them fly to India for gold,
Ransack the ocean for orient pearl,
And search all corners of the new-found world
For pleasant fruits and princely delicates.
I'll have them read me strange philosophy
And tell the secrets of all foreign kings.
I'll have them wall all Germany with brass
And make swift Rhine circle fair Wittenberg.
I'll have them fill the public schools with silk,
Wherewith the students shall be bravely clad.

I'll levy soldiers with the coin they bring
And chase the Prince of Parma from our land,
And reign sole king of all the provinces;
Yea, stranger engines for the brunt of war
Than was the fiery keel at Antwerp bridge
I'll make my servile spirits to invent.
Come, German Valdes and Cornelius,
And make me blest with your sage conference!

Enter Valdes and Cornelius

Valdes, sweet Valdes, and Cornelius,
Know that your words have won me at the last
To practise magic and concealèd arts.
Philosophy is odious and obscure;
Both law and physic are for petty wits;
'Tis magic, magic that hath ravished me.
Then, gentle friends, aid me in this attempt,
And I, that have with subtle syllogisms
Gravelled the pastors of the German Church
And made the flow'ring pride of Wittenberg
Swarm to my problems as th'infernal spirits
On sweet Musaeus when he came to hell,
Will be as cunning as Agrippa was,
Whose shadow made all Europe honour him.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the Duchess and Bosola
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 2

CARIOLA Hence villains, tyrants, murderers! Alas,
What will you do with my lady? – Call for help.

DUCHESS To whom? To our next neighbours? They are mad-folks.

BOSOLA Remove that noise.

[Executioners seize Cariola]

DUCHESS Farewell, Cariola.

In my last will I have not much to give;
A many hungry guests have fed upon me,
Thine will be a poor reversion.

CARIOLA I will die with her.

DUCHESS I pray thee look thou giv'st my little boy
Some syrup for his cold, and let the girl
Say her prayers, ere she sleep.

[Executioners force Cariola off]

Now what you please:

What death?

BOSOLA Strangling: here are your executioners.

DUCHESS I forgive them:

The apoplexy, catarrh, or cough o'th' lungs
Would do as much as they do.

BOSOLA Doth not death fright you?

DUCHESS Who would be afraid on't,
Knowing to meet such excellent company
In th' other world?

BOSOLA Yet, methinks,

The manner of your death should much afflict you,
This cord should terrify you?

DUCHESS

Not a whit.

What would it pleasure me to have my throat cut
With diamonds? or to be smothered
With cassia? or to be shot to death with pearls?
I know death hath ten thousand several doors
For men to take their exits; and 'tis found
They go on such strange geometrical hinges,
You may open them both ways. Any way, for heaven' sake,
So I were out of your whispering. Tell my brothers
That I perceive death, now I am well awake,
Best gift is they can give, or I can take.
I would fain put off my last woman's fault,
I'd not be tedious to you.

EXECUTIONER

We are ready.

DUCHESS Dispose my breath how please you, but my body
Bestow upon my women, will you?

EXECUTIONER

Yes.

DUCHESS Pull, and pull strongly, for your able strength
Must pull down heaven upon me.

Yet stay; heaven' gates are not so highly arched
As princes' palaces; they that enter there
Must go upon their knees. [*Kneels*] Come, violent death,
Serve for mandragora to make me sleep.
Go tell my brothers, when I am laid out,
They then may feed in quiet.

They strangle her

BOSOLA Where's the waiting-woman?

Fetch her. Some other strangle the children.

[Executioners bring Cariola, and some go to strangle the children.]

Look you, there sleeps your mistress.

CARIOLA

O, you are damned

Perpetually for this. My turn is next,
Is't not so ordered?

BOSOLA

Yes, and I am glad

You are so well prepared for't.

CARIOLA

You are deceived sir,

I am not prepared for't, I will not die;
I will first come to my answer, and know
How I have offended.

BOSOLA

Come, despatch her.

You kept her counsel, now you shall keep ours.

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0 6

Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

'The main tragic and dramatic function of Biff and Happy in *Death of a Salesman* is to reveal Willy Loman's flaws.'

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0 7

Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

'At the end of *A Streetcar Named Desire* life is shown to have triumphed over death.'

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0 8

Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

'Always more her father's daughter than her husband's wife. That is her tragedy.'

How do you respond to Ibsen's presentation of Hedda Gabler in the light of this comment?

[25 marks]

or

0 9

Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

To what extent do you agree that the tragic elements of *Waiting for Godot* are more apparent in Act II than in Act I?

[25 marks]

or

1 0

Brian Friel: *Translations*

Is *Translations* essentially a tragic love story?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

